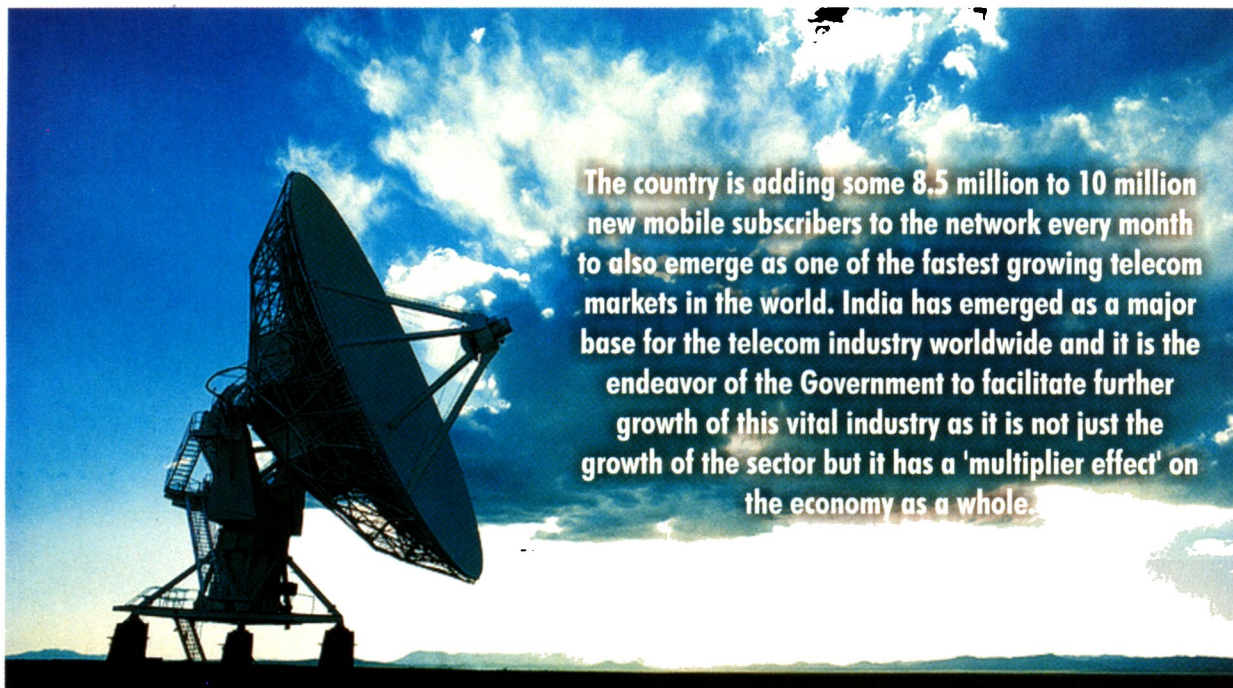




The country is adding some 8.5 million to 10 million new mobile subscribers to the network every month to also emerge as one of the fastest growing telecom markets in the world. India has emerged as a major base for the telecom industry worldwide and it is the endeavor of the Government to facilitate further growth of this vital industry as it is not just the growth of the sector but it has a 'multiplier effect' on the economy as a whole.

EXCITING TIMES AHEAD

The target of 500 million telephone connections by the year 2010 is very much achievable. Even with 300 million telephone connections, the tele-density of the country is only about 26 percent. Mobile telephony is growing at an annual rate of over 90 percent. On an average over eight million subscribers are being added every month. Besides the basic telephone service, there is a huge potential for different value added services. The sector has been attracting significant domestic and global investments.

Now India is well prepared for next generation mobile services with the introduction of Next Generation Networking (NGN) services. TRAI has identified introduction of NGN as a priority area.

The tariffs for telecom services in India are one of the lowest in the world right now. The reduction in cost of the mobile handsets along with the low tariff has made the handset a part of our day to day life. There is a direct relationship between tariff reduction and increase in the number of telephone connections. In India the revenue model of the telecom companies are based on volumes.

Samsung Touch S8300

Slated to be the flagship edition to the company's stylish Ultra range, the S8300 is a slider phone that features a 2.8" AMOLED anti-scratch full touch screen. The phone is ultra-slim at 12.7mm and boasts of a brushed metal frame for durability and an anti-scratch, anti-smudge screen. The camera is an eight-mega pixel unit with dual power LED flash and smile shot mode. Other features include GPS navigation, geo-tagging via the GPS chip that allows you to tag photos with geographic information, 30fps VGA video recording and HSDPA 7.2 Mbps. There is 80MB of onboard memory, with support for Micro SD cards up to 16GB to take care of your storage woes.



Nokia E75

The Nokia E75, the ultimate email efficiency device, offers the best in class corporate and consumer email experience via pre-installed clients. It is the first Nokia device to offer Nokia Messaging Service, a consumer email solution that combines different ways to communicate in one simple package. It offers an easy 3 step process for instant email set up and supports up to 16 email accounts including Gmail, Yahoo, Rediffmail, Sify, Indiatimes, Net4, Hotmail and In.com. The new 'mini communicator', the Nokia E75 boasts full desktop email functionality along with both standard keypad and QWERTY keypad. The device features a 3.2 megapixel camera, autofocus, flash, integrated music player, FM, A-GPS, & built-in mobile VPN.



The convergence of technologies and emergence of new applications is another thrilling area. Lot of revolution is round the corner in broadcasting and entertainment industries. The emergence of 3G Services, Internet Protocol TV, Mobile TV and Mobile Number Portability (MNP) will all change the scenario in the coming years.

Wireless technology is the future growth driver for which spectrum is the most important input. The task of spectrum management in a multi user and multi usage scenario is more daunting and crucial than ever before. In summary, the next few years would prove to be even more exciting for the telecom industry in the country, not just for domestic players, but the global companies as well.

Larger efforts are continuously being made to provide universal service to all uncovered areas including rural areas. The challenge of the day is to search for new cost-effective ways to roll out telecom services in rural areas. It means one has to choose proper and effective technology for deployment and leverage on the use of available infrastructure to reduce cost and time of roll out of services. Those service providers who create the right business would emerge winners and the rest would remain spectators.